

Nigel Chao

Game Designer
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SUMMARY

- 2+ years of experience in software engineering with academic training in Game & Interaction Design.
- Hands-on development experience with critical evaluation skills to analyze gameplay systems, UX, and market potential with gameplay deconstruction and mechanics analysis.
- Global experience across Asia and Europe - polyglot in English, Mandarin, Cantonese, Portuguese, basic Swedish.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer | Repli5

2022 - 2024

- Developed 15+ features using Python for WorldGenerator, a Blender add-on that automates the creation of 3D environments by working in diverse domains such as Backend, UI, Technical Writing, and DevOps.
- Drove over 100+ Scrum ceremonies, fostering a culture of collaboration and continuous improvement.
- Reformed and drove the UI team, integrating the UI/UX of 13+ features closely with development processes by setting 50+ weekly meetings to implement collaborative feedback, continuously improving the UI/UX for upcoming features.
- Streamlined build and deployment processes by scripting automation for various build stages, including artifact creation and deployment across environments using Google Cloud and Bitbucket Pipelines.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Game Designer | “Scarab Descent”

2024

- Designed and greyboxed a **non-linear world map** in UE5 using a modular kit, emphasizing genre staples such as exploration and ability gated progression for a single player Metroidvania FPS vertical slice.
- Drafted design documents outlining enemy placement and mechanics enhancing combat and pacing of player flow.
- Designed tutorial and AI driven areas to reduce learning curves of newly acquired abilities.
- Scripted AI, combat and traversal mechanics using Blueprints and GAS (Gameplay Ability System).

EDUCATION

Master’s in Computer Science, Major in Game & Interaction Design

Chalmers & University of Gothenburg | Graduated 2022

- Thesis: Player Environmental Awareness: Rules of Thumb for Environmental Storytelling in Role-Playing Games
- Analyzed 4+ games and mechanics for academic projects, identifying patterns, breakdowns of core loops, and analyzing emergent behaviours from gameplay.
- Prototyped a 2D platformer and AR game in Unity, iterating core gameplay based on feedback.

Bachelor’s in Computer Science, Major in Software Engineering & Management

Chalmers & University of Gothenburg | Graduated 2020

SKILLS

- Game & System Design
- Gameplay Deconstruction & Feature Analysis
- Prototyping & Iteration
- Software Architecture
- DevOps and CI/CD
- Technical Writing & Documentation
- Agile methodologies

TECHNOLOGIES

- **Programming:** Python, C#, C/C++, Bash, Blueprints
- **Version Control:** Git, Perforce, Plastic SCM
- **Collaboration Tools:** Miro, Figma, Jira, Notion, Trello
- **Game Engines:** Unity, Unreal Engine
- **3D Modeling:** Blender
- **Containerization:** Docker
- **Writing:** GDDs, player personas, user stories, process flows